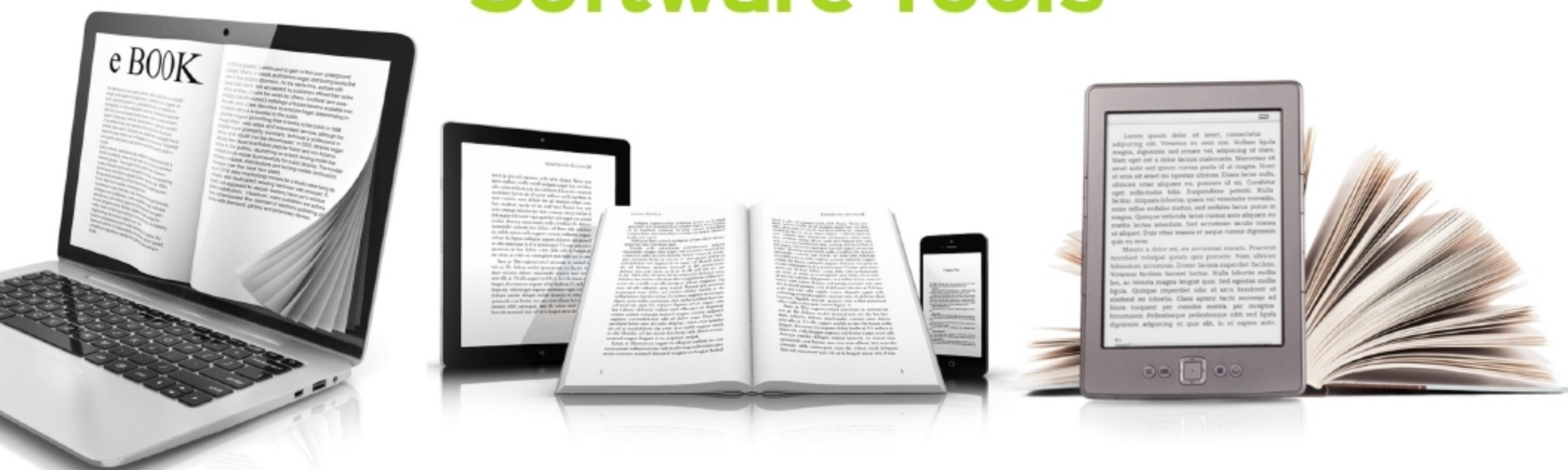


Generating Digital Content with Cross-Platform Software Tools



All of us consume digital content every day in some form or the other, be it an e-zine, an e-newspaper or an online research report. This article lists a few open source software tools that aid the generation of such content.

Digital content is required for assorted applications such as authoring and publishing e-books, e-magazines, tutorials, e-notebooks, infographics, book reviews, research reports, corporate white papers, government reports, research, and so on.

Electronic publication also supports students by providing content and analytics when they prepare for their examinations, without the need for hard copies of different books. Students can now get content from international authors across the globe by accessing the Web and mobile applications of digital publishers. E-publication offers a broad variety of books that may not be accessible to readers through the regular bookstore due to the lack of demand for conventional printed copies. E-publishing allows independent writers to sell books that conventional publishers may be reluctant to take on due to low profitability. It is becoming more and more popular for children's stories and enriching their knowledge in assorted domains.

Though electronic publication (also known as Internet publishing or website publishing) is nowadays very popular, various non-network electronic publications, such as CD and DVD encyclopaedias, and technological and reference publications are also being relied upon by smartphone users.

Amazon.com has a digital publishing division with its own website for self-published books under Kindle Direct Publishing. Developers can create and launch games and applications in Google Play Store without third party intervention. Musicians can record and upload their music to iTunes, which digitally publishes the music and makes it open to iPods, iPhones and other devices. The authors can use their delivery network, which is a type of digital publication, when you listen to Pandora, Spotify and all other music services online.

It often takes three to six months to plan and print magazines and catalogues. Digital copies can be obtained in a fraction of the time for everyone to view. When printing is finished, it is too late to add material, photographs or to fix errors. Quick, convenient and inexpensive updates are available for digital publications.

Digital catalogues allow users to click for more details or to place instant orders, unlike printed catalogues. E-catalogues can also allow customers to access feedback and evaluations or voice their views on a product. The impulse buyer is much more susceptible to Internet catalogues than to a paper edition.

Without giving up your own copy, multimedia catalogues can be exchanged with friends, families and

